

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Mostly sunny, breezy 43/31 • Tomorrow: Rain 40/36 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2025 • \$4

Trump call with Putin a jolt for Kyiv, allies

Ukraine, Europe fear exclusion from peace talks vital to their future

BY SIOBHÁN O'GRADY AND ELLEN FRANCIS

KYIV — President Donald Trump's phone call to Russian President Vladimir Putin has deeply rattled Kyiv and its European partners, intensifying long-held fears that Ukraine could be excluded from peace talks determining its own future and security — as well as that of the rest of the continent.

Trump, who spoke to Putin on Wednesday and then phoned Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky to inform him of the call, said he and his Russian counterpart will try to meet soon in Saudi Arabia, without the Ukrainian leader.

The announcement of the Trump-Putin call, which made no mention of Europe, and the pending meeting between the two men also play into the fears of European leaders that their defense interests will fall by the wayside if Trump sidelines them in talks with Russia. Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said Thursday that it was “premature” to discuss a role for Europe in any talks.

The reaction from Moscow, which has in the past maintained a reserved tone toward Trump's statements, has been practically gleeful since the call. Peskov called the new U.S. position to end the conflict “impressive,” while Russian lawmakers hailed it as the start of a new era in relations. John Bolton, a former Trump national security adviser, **SEE UKRAINE ON A13**

Moscow elated: Russian officials hail Trump's call as a victory. **A13**

Trade talks advance as Modi visits White House



JABIN BOTSFORD/THE WASHINGTON POST

The United States and India are moving toward a deal aimed at cutting the \$45 billion U.S. trade deficit in that partnership, President Donald Trump said as he hosted Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday. **Story, A12**

RFK Jr., anti-vaccine activist, gets top health post

BY LAUREN WEBER AND RACHEL ROUBEIN

The Senate confirmed Robert F. Kennedy Jr. to lead the Department of Health and Human Services, placing a member of the storied Democratic family in President Donald Trump's Cabinet and giving the anti-vaccine activist oversight of the nation's nearly \$2 trillion health portfolio.

The former presidential candidate turned leader of the “Make America Healthy Again” movement was officially sworn in

Kennedy is sworn in as HHS secretary after long confirmation battle

Thursday as the leader of the vast government apparatus that oversees critical health insurance programs, the safety of the nation's drug and food supply, and the response to infectious-disease outbreaks — influencing health policies that touch all corners of American life.

As one of Trump's most controversial nominees, Kennedy was confirmed in a 52-48 vote largely along party lines, with Sen. Mitch McConnell (R-Kentucky) as the lone exception.

McConnell's childhood bout with polio has informed his ardent support for vaccines amid increasing skepticism of the shots within his own party.

“I will not condone the re-litigation of proven cures, and neither will millions of Americans who credit their survival and quality of life to scientific miracles,” the longtime former Re-

publican leader said in a statement.

Kennedy secured the Cabinet seat despite his liberal credentials, well-funded lobbying efforts against him and opposition over his support for abortion rights led by Trump's former vice president, Mike Pence.

Kennedy's confirmation victory underscores Trump's hold on the Republican Party. When Trump announced many of his **SEE RFK JR. ON A7**

Lone GOP opponent: McConnell votes “no” on Trump nominees. **A7**

U.S. plan to match other countries' tariffs leaves time for negotiations

BY DAVID J. LYNCH, RACHEL SIEGEL AND ANTHONY FAIOLA

President Donald Trump continued his relentless remaking of U.S. trade relations on Thursday, announcing a new policy of taxing foreign goods at the same rate that other nations apply to American products.

The president billed his new “reciprocal” tariff policy as a straightforward response to unfair behavior by U.S. trading part-

ners, who in some cases apply higher tariffs to specific American goods than the United States applies to the same products from those countries.

But in signing a presidential memorandum, he ordered no change in current tariff rates, instead directing his top aides to prepare a report on the steps needed to balance the scales with each of the more than 200 countries, territories and regional associations that the United States trades with. That report should be com-

plete by April 1, according to Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, one of those charged with preparing it.

“If you build your product in the United States, there are no tariffs,” Trump said from the Oval Office. He said the levies would be applied on top of previously announced steel and aluminum tariffs, adding that such policies “should have been done years ago.”

“Reciprocity may sound appealing. But remember who pays **SEE TARIFFS ON A15**

Orders targeting trans health care on hold

BY JENNA PORTNOY AND SALVADOR RIZZO

A federal judge on Thursday blocked executive orders signed by President Donald Trump that target transgender people and their health care, giving temporary relief to LGBTQ+ individuals and their families, who braced for legal battles to continue.

At least one health system — the hospital affiliated with the University of Virginia — said it would resume providing services that had been paused under the order.

U.S. District Judge Brendan A. Hurson, who was appointed in 2023 by President Joe Biden, granted a temporary restraining

Judge temporarily blocks Trump's threat to pull funds from providers

order effective for at least 14 days after a hearing in federal court in Baltimore. The government is expected to appeal the decision, which legal experts said could ultimately go to the Supreme Court.

“This is a population with an extremely higher rate for suicide, poverty, unemployment, drug addiction,” Hurson said during the hearing. Abruptly stopping their health treatments, he said, would

be “horribly dangerous for anyone, for any care, but particularly for this extremely vulnerable population.”

Despite the ruling, which applies to hospitals and clinics nationwide, patients and their families remained in limbo as it was unclear whether all hospitals that had suspended care planned to resume treatment. A judge in Seattle is also set to hold a hearing Friday on a similar challenge to the transition care order. **SEE HEALTH CARE ON A6**

Letter to Congress: Trump wants more power to fire regulators. **A2**

USAID: Judge extends pause on plan to put employees on leave. **A4**



FAIOLA FERRERO FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Bouquets from Bogotá

A worker packs roses at a farm in Colombia. Americans' fondness for flowers has flourished in recent years, and Colombia is a leading source of fresh-cut stems. **Story, A10**

A long record of alerts for helicopters near National

104 collision warnings in past decade show steady risk before fiery tragedy

This article is by Ian Duncan, Daniel Gilbert, Michael Laris, Lori Aratani and Andrew Ba Tran

Airline pilots received more than 100 cockpit warnings over the past decade that they were in danger of a midair collision with a helicopter near Reagan National Airport, according to flight-tracking and government incident data, a record of repeated risks compiled by air traffic controllers before the Jan. 29 crash that killed 67 people.

A Washington Post examination of the records reveals the potential for an airborne collision was more frequent near the airport than has been previously disclosed. Each of the incidents reviewed by The Post triggered an automated cockpit warning advising airliner pilots to take action to avoid a collision — causing them in many cases to abort landings or change flight paths.

The Federal Aviation Administration, which employs the nation's **SEE HELICOPTERS ON A9**

IN THE NEWS

Kennedy Center Staff members described a climate of fear as Trump takes control, and one artist canceled her upcoming show. **A20**

Resignations at DOJ An acting U.S. attorney and five other agency officials have quit after an order to drop corruption charges against New York Mayor Eric Adams. **A20**

THE NATION A CDC report shows some vets who cared for cattle were infected with bird flu last year. **A2**
Shake-ups at the FBI and the DOJ have led to notable absences at a daily threats meeting. **A8**

THE WORLD Freed Israeli hostages told families of being tortured while they were held by Hamas. **A11**
A car plowed into a crowd in Munich in what authorities called a “suspected attack.” **A13**

THE ECONOMY Bad weather and crop disease have reduced cocoa supplies, leading to higher chocolate prices just in time for Valentine's Day. **A14**
Two key lawmakers warned that a British demand for access to Apple users' encrypted data imperils Americans. **A15**

THE REGION Trump's cuts will affect Republican Gov. Glenn Youngkin's effort to create “laboratory” schools in Virginia. **B1**
Wealthy Marylanders would see the largest tax hikes under Gov. Wes Moore's plan, but some middle-income earners would also pay more. **B1**

STYLE Oscar-nominated Fernanda Torres embodies the courage required to stare down a dictatorship in “I'm Still Here.” **C1**

WEEKEND A guide to offline human connection, featuring regular gatherings in the area to suit a variety of hobbies and interests.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A14
COMICS.....C5
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A17
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A10

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54127

